On the other hand, he strove to bolster the Abraham Accords and reach an agreement with Saudi Arabia. All of this is now in ruins, or nearly so. And yet, one cannot deny that throughout his several premierships, Netanyahu was anything but a firebrand. In fact, he was extremely cautious during previous outbreaks of hostility with Hamas, postponing moves that could have led to a wider conflict. His present refusal to opt for a limited ceasefire stems, in my opinion, from the pressure of the minister of defense and the army, who expect tangible results within a short time. To make his procrastination palatable to the Americans, he uses the liberation of the hostages as the prerequisite for a ceasefire, but how long will he be able to use this argument against US demands?

Smotrich, our despicable finance minister, tried to withhold the payment of tax money Israel owes to the Palestine Authority. Today, the cabinet decided on transferring the money after a strong intervention by Defense Minister Gallant.

Friday, November 3

Nasrallah's speech did not disclose much: on the one hand, he described the Hamas aggression as 100 percent Palestinian, even mentioning that he had not been warned of it. On the other, he did not exclude the possibility of widening the conflict. In this guessing game, I would venture to predict that Hezbollah will keep to its present limits and not start a full-scale war.

The troops engaged in Gaza seem to be progressing inside Gaza City itself. One of the units is getting close to Al-Shifa Hospital.

Despite the general progress of ground forces, there are repeated warnings from Israeli military spokespeople that the operations will take a long time. Is that intentional disinformation? It had better be, as Israel does not have much time. The United States will soon ask for not only a humanitarian ceasefire but a cessation of the military campaign as such.